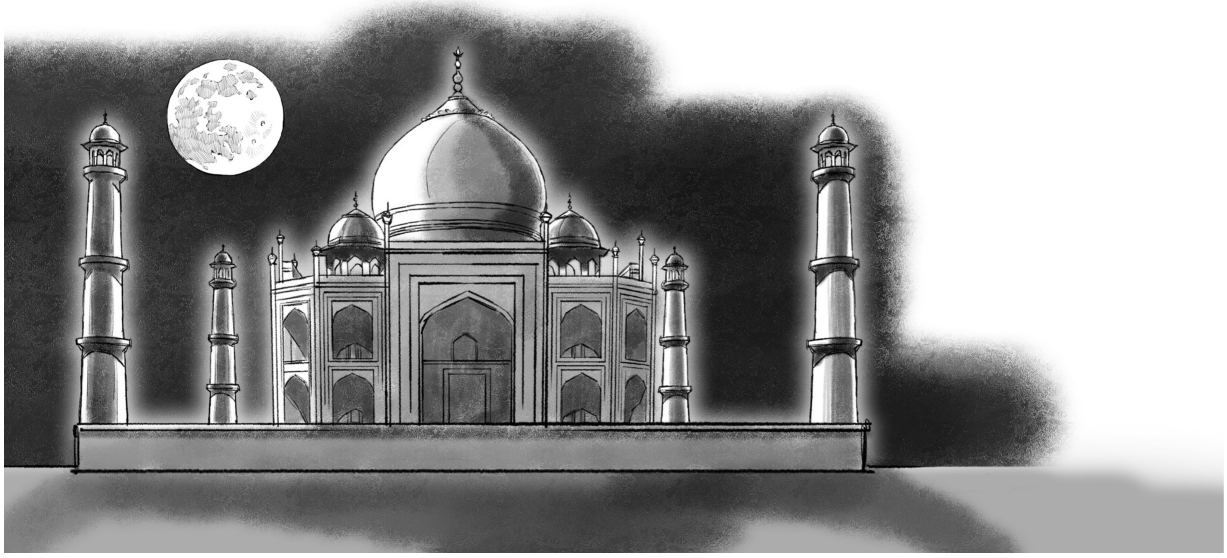
When the moon is full and the sky is clear, the Taj Mahal still seems to shimmer just the way it did in his time, three and a half centuries ago.



Myths of the Taj Mahal

Ever since the Taj Mahal was built, myths about it have spread. The most common one is that Shah Jahan intended to build an identical tomb, made of black stone, for himself. As the story goes, he wasn't able to do that because his son took him prisoner.

The overall design of the Taj Mahal complex shows that Shah Jahan probably didn't plan a second tomb. The discovery of a moonlight garden on the other side of the river shows that the white-domed tomb was the center of a symmetrical complex. Putting a second tomb in the complex would have spoiled that plan.

Another myth is that the workers on the Taj Mahal had their hands cut off. This was supposed to guarantee that they couldn't build anything else as grand. The story is not true. Shah Jahan had other building projects. Finding workers to do those jobs would have been difficult if that was the "reward" for doing a good job!